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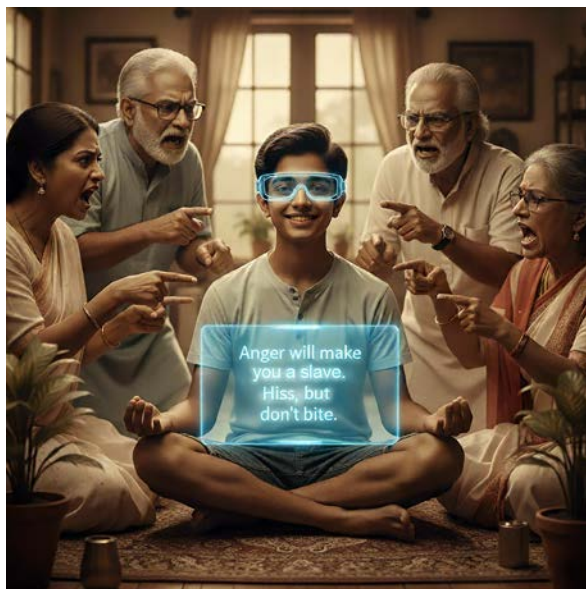
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Samskriti Darshanam— Preventive Mental Wellbeing Utilising AI and Mixed Reality

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THE TERM INDIAN Knowledge Systems (IKS) denotes the comprehensive, indigenous, holistic framework of intellectual, cultural, scientific, and philosophical thought that was systematically developed and transmitted across the Indian subcontinent for several millennia.¹ Philosophy and Spirituality comprise a major portion of IKS that includes the six Darshanas, of which Yoga-Vedanta is the prominent one. Sri Ramakrishna has given us the path of synthesis—of Yoga and Vedanta, of devotion and knowledge, of work and worship—as the most suited for the practical modern age.² These spiritual traditions provide not just a framework for understanding the world where we live but also a set of practical tools for living a more meaningful and fulfilling life. Although Indian spiritual traditions offer a wealth of insights relevant to mental well-being, *this knowledge remains largely underutilised within*

*mainstream Western psychotherapy.*³ These Yoga-Vedanta traditions are fundamentally practical and experiential; they are not meant to be merely studied as academic subjects. The core reason for putting these into practice is that the ultimate aim is self-transformation, not just academic research.

Indian Knowledge Systems as Spiritual Methodologies: From Principle to Practice

Swami Vivekananda stressed the importance of the practicality of spiritual knowledge systems in a lecture titled ‘Practical Vedanta’ at San Francisco, California (Nov 1896), and he proclaimed:

I have been asked to say something about the practical position of the Vedanta philosophy. As I have told you, theory is very good indeed, but how are we to carry it into practice? If it be absolutely impracticable, no theory is of

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any value whatever, except as intellectual gymnastics. The Vedanta, therefore, as a religion must be intensely practical. We must be able to carry it out in every part of our lives. The ideals of religion must cover the whole field of life, they must enter into all our thoughts, and more and more into practice.⁴

Psychological Barriers in Spiritual Pursuit

Our attempts to navigate life's journey with a practical spiritual pursuit can lead to obstacles. Our reactions to these obstacles may, in turn, cause conflicting psychological responses. *In human behavioural psychology, this is exemplified by a pattern called 'Spiritual bypass,'* which the renowned psychologist Dr Ingrid Clayton defines as 'a defense mechanism by which we use spiritual practices or beliefs to avoid our emotional wounds, unwanted thoughts or impulses, or threats to our self-esteem'.⁵ Swami Yatiswaranandaji, a renowned monk of Ramakrishna Order, in his book 'Adventures in Religious life' writes:

Swami Vivekananda warned his brother disciples of further hazards and hurdles confronting spiritual aspirants. He said that eighty per cent of those who take to spiritual life become hypocrites; it is easier to be a hypocrite, to make an outward show without changing inwardly, than to pass through all the troubles and difficulties of intense spiritual life. Fifteen per cent become insane ... Five per cent of those who start spiritual life and steadily purify themselves move towards the goal.⁶

Origins of Samsmriti Darshanam: Constant Remembrance and Insightful Seeing

Embarking on this spiritual life adventure requires continuous practical training with the right understanding. This training involves the constant remembrance of Yoga-Vedantic practices, modelled after our spiritual predecessors. These examples serve as 'spiritual case

studies,' allowing us to learn and deploy their proven methodologies in our own real-world life situations. Sri Ramakrishna, in his *Gospel*, says, 'I don't care for japa and austerity. But I have constant remembrance and consciousness of God.'⁷ Holy Mother Sri Sarada Devi also advocates constant remembrance of God for spiritual aspirants.⁸ Swami Vivekananda, in his lecture on Bhakti, says, 'Meditation again is a constant remembrance flowing like an unbroken stream of oil poured out from one vessel to another. When this kind of remembering has been attained, all bondages break. Thus it is spoken of in the scriptures regarding constant remembering as a means to liberation. This remembering again is of the same form as seeing ... This remembrance when exalted assumes the same form as seeing.'⁹

In the Yoga-Vedantic framework, Samsmriti denotes the disciplined process of recollection and sustained remembrance of spiritual knowledge. *It represents a dynamic state of awareness* wherein sacred insights, transmitted through the realisations of spiritual predecessors, are internalised and consciously applied in daily life. This act of remembrance serves as a practical tool for self-purification, gradually dissolving the layers of ignorance and psychological conditioning that obscure the perception of our true nature. Darshanam or insightful seeing extends beyond the sensory act of sight and augments intuitive or revelatory perception. Samsmriti and Darshanam thus form complementary dimensions of spiritual understanding—remembrance evolving into direct perception, and perception deepening remembrance. Building on these philosophical foundations, the concept of Samsmriti Darshanam proposes an innovative synthesis between ancient contemplative methodologies and emerging cognitive technologies.



Bridging Traditional Emotional Wellness Practices with Emerging Modern Technologies

The convergence of emotional wellness practices rooted in IKS with emerging modern technologies represents a rapidly evolving field and has the potential to transform the mental well-being of the younger generation. Recent research demonstrates significant potential in combining ancient wisdom systems with modern technological interventions for mental well-being applications.¹⁰ The scientific rationale for the Samsmriti Darshanam platform is grounded in addressing a fundamental challenge of modern life: the growing disconnect between the profound, time-tested ancient Indian wisdom and the practical, moment-to-moment application of these principles in our real-world rife with stress, anxiety, and loneliness. While philosophies like Yoga and Vedanta offer practical frameworks for achieving mental equilibrium, their translation into daily practice remains a significant hurdle for many. The platform proposes to bridge this ‘principle-to-practice’

gap by creating a holistic, technology-driven ecosystem.

Leveraging the capabilities of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Mixed Reality (MR)—a combination of Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR)—this framework seeks to create context-sensitive immersive environments that stimulate reflective awareness and insight. AI systems can model user-specific emotional and cognitive states to provide adaptive guidance rooted in scriptural or meditative wisdom, while MR environments can render augmented visual metaphors and experiential simulations corresponding to the practitioner’s situational context. These experiences act as digital contemplative aids, resonating with spiritual principles through visualisation, interaction, and reflection.

Transforming the Mental Health Crisis Into Preventive Mental Well-Being

Samsmriti Darshanam confronts India’s unprecedented youth mental health crisis by pioneering a convergence of Indian Knowledge Systems with Generative AI and Mixed Reality (AR/VR). This framework addresses the 371 million young Indians¹¹—the world’s largest youth demographic from ages 15 to 29—grappling with academic pressure, career uncertainty, and digital overwhelm. It directly tackles the systemic gaps fueling this crisis: a severe shortage of mental health professionals (only 0.75 per 100,000 people) and the pervasive stigma that prevents help-seeking.¹²

The platform’s revolutionary strength lies in an integrated ecosystem that makes ancient Yoga-Vedanta wisdom practically accessible via real-time, technology-powered interventions. Unlike Western-centric digital health apps, Samsmriti Darshanam leverages India’s own philosophical heritage. It transforms abstract concepts from

Ramakrishna-Vivekananda-Yoga-Vedanta literature into actionable, personalised interventions, delivered at the precise moment of need.

Bridging the Philosophical Framework with Technological Architecture

The technological architecture of Samsmriti Darshanam represents a paradigm shift: multimodal biosensing via wearables, brain-computer interfaces (BCI), Augmented Reality glasses, and audio devices that continuously monitor emotional states using physiological markers like Heart rate variability (HRV), Electroencephalogram (EEG), and Electrodermal activity (EDA), as well as subjective mood journaling and facial expression analysis. A Generative AI engine processes this data to deliver culturally resonant interventions—ranging from subtle AR overlays of scriptural verses during stressful moments to immersive VR experiences featuring narrative-driven scenarios addressing modern youth challenges. Its closed-loop biofeedback system enables proactive emotional regulation, building resilience that prevents escalation of mental health problems. The four interconnected scientific pillars of this architecture are as follows:

a) Objective and Multimodal Sensing: The platform moves beyond purely subjective self-reports of emotional states by a multimodal sensory suite of Wearables (Watch/Ring with health sensors-body), Knowable systems (BCI—head), Viewables (AR glass with camera-eyes) and Hearables (Earbuds with mic ears), to identify the emotional well-being of the person. This approach is rooted in the field of affective computing, which aims to recognize and interpret human emotions from physiological and behavioural signals.¹³ By fusing this objective data with contextual information—such as facial analysis from selfie photos/videos and subjective



input from a mood journal—the system can build a comprehensive, multi-layered understanding of a user’s emotional state in real-time.

b) AI-Powered Personalisation: A core premise is that for an intervention to be effective, it must be personalised and contextually relevant. The platform leverages a Generative AI engine to serve as the system’s cognitive core. This AI is designed to synthesize the multimodal data streams to learn an individual’s unique emotional patterns and triggers. It then tailors interventions from the rich library of Ramakrishna-Vivekananda-Yoga-Vedantic teachings based not only on the immediate emotional need but also on the user’s profile, including age, cultural background, and specific life challenges. This creates a highly personalised therapeutic experience that a static, one-size-fits-all application cannot provide.

c) Immersive and Contextual Delivery: The platform utilises Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR) as a powerful dual medium for delivering interventions. Through Augmented Reality (AR), the system can overlay non-intrusive prompts and cues—such as a scriptural verse or a breathing cue—directly into the user’s field of view during a real-world stressful event. For more intensive practice, VR can immerse the user in a serene, controlled

environment, free from external distractions, for guided meditation with aurally immersive chants/bhajans and visually immersive media content with real-life emotional well-being case studies derived from Yoga-Vedantic practices. This can be paired with visually immersive media content inspired by the narrative style of moral storytellers like ‘Dharmannl’,¹⁴ the immersive content could be based on short, relatable, real-life emotional case studies derived from these spiritual practices. This style uses simple narratives to illustrate a moral or philosophical point, showing a clear transformation from a state of distress to one of resolution. Research has shown that the immersive nature of VR can enhance the benefits by increasing focus and emotional regulation.¹⁵

d) Closed-Loop Biofeedback: The integration of these components creates a dynamic, closed-loop biofeedback system. The system continuously senses the user’s physiological state, the AI interprets this data to select or generate an appropriate intervention, and MR delivers it. This immediate feedback loop empowers users to actively practise emotional self-regulation in the very moments they need it most, reinforcing the practical application of Yoga-Vedantic principles in their daily lives.

Real-World Interventions for Primary Behavioural Psychological Responses

Behavioural psychology identifies primary stress responses—Fight and Flight, followed by later additions—Freeze and Fawn—as instinctive mechanisms of the autonomic nervous system in response to perceived threat or distress.¹⁶ In the Yoga-Vedantic view, these correspond to fluctuations of the *manas* (mind), *buddhi* (intellect), and *ahamkara* (ego), manifesting as reactions rooted in *avidya* (ignorance).

Samsmriti Darshanam aims to transform

these instinctive patterns through constant remembrance (Samsmriti) and insightful perception (Darshanam), cultivating reflective awareness that transcends reaction. By leveraging AI & MR, this approach models how ancient self-regulation techniques can be practised through experiential learning environments, making spiritual resilience a tangible, trainable skill.

a) Fight Response — Transforming Anger into Dynamic Self-Control

The fight response arises when an individual reacts to a threat with aggression, control, or confrontation.

Spiritual Antidote

Sri Ramakrishna’s parable of the snake—which was taught non-violence but was told to ‘hiss’ (show strength) without ‘biting’ (causing harm)—is the perfect model. It’s the shift from reactive aggression to controlled, conscious action.¹⁷

Sri Ramakrishna’s instruction to his disciple Niranjan is not to retaliate with catastrophic anger (sinking the boat) but instead teaches indifference to provocation, where anger, if it must arise, should be ‘like a mark on water’—vanishing instantly without causing collateral harm to oneself or others.¹⁸

Swami Vivekananda in ‘Law and Freedom’ lecture reiterates the need to avoid angry reactions — ‘As soon as we react, we become slaves. A man blames me, and I immediately react in the form of anger. A little vibration which he created made me a slave. So, we have to demonstrate our freedom.’¹⁹

Technological intervention

Samsmriti Darshanam platform detects biomarkers of anger (Example: raised voice using a hearable device, high heart rate via a wearable device). Based on one’s personalised

preferences, it provides a non-intrusive Samsmriti cue in his smart AR glass: 'Anger will make you a slave. Hiss, but don't bite.'

The platform then prompts the individual to engage with an immersive multi-sensory VR experience of the anecdote between 'Sri Ramakrishna and Niranjan', followed by the 'Snake and Brahmachari' parable. Later, when the user feels a real-world 'fight' response, it's much easier to recall the feeling of being calmed by Sri Ramakrishna.

b) 'Flight' Response — From Avoidance to Awareness

The flight response involves avoidance of threat or discomfort—escaping through distraction, denial, or detachment.

Spiritual Antidote

Swami Vivekananda's lesson to 'Face the brutes' is the perfect antidote for the flight response. When he stopped fleeing the monkeys and boldly confronted them, they retreated.²⁰ This incident provides the core methodology for Samsmriti Darshanam: it is the conscious shift from fearful avoidance to bold confrontation, teaching us that life's hardships and inner demons collapse when we cease to flee before them.

Swami Vivekananda's 'Father Stag and Son Stag' story illustrates the gap between intellectual confidence and experiential strength. Like the stag proud of its power yet fleeing at the dogs' bark, humans often boast of virtue and courage but collapse when faced with real trials.²¹ Swami Vivekananda offers this as a spiritual antidote—reminding seekers that Samsmriti (constant remembrance) and perseverance in practice alone transform theoretical strength into steadfast realisation.

Technological intervention

Based on a combination of bio-markers and subjective mood journals, the platform



provides a Samsmriti cue in the AR glass: 'Face the brute. Be fearless.'

The platform then prompts the individual to watch an immersive multi-sensory VR experience of the anecdote 'Face the brute', followed by the 'Father and Son Stag' parable.

Impact and Innovation

The potential of the Samsmriti Darshanam platform extends beyond individual wellness to societal impact. Samsmriti Darshanam democratises mental health support by offering scalable, private, stigma-free interventions accessible through everyday technology. With a deficit of mental health professionals for the Indian youth population and ever-increasing suicide rates, there is an urgent need for a scalable and accessible first line of support. The AI-driven platform can reach millions of young people in both urban and rural areas,

providing on-demand assistance without the long wait times and high costs associated with traditional therapy. It effectively puts a personalised emotional well-being mentor in every pocket, bridging the vast gap between need and availability.

The platform shifts the paradigm from reactive treatment to proactive well-being. By monitoring mental and emotional states in real time, the system can provide ‘in-the-moment’ interventions that help users manage stress as it arises. This is particularly impactful for the younger generation, as it equips them with the practical skills for emotional regulation needed to navigate the pressures of daily life. It doesn’t just treat distress; it builds the resilience needed to prevent it. It also empowers the users to identify their emotional patterns and triggers healthier responses, which eventually become habitual, integrating with the personality of the youth.

For a generation that is digitally native, Samsmriti Darshanam makes the profound and often abstract teachings of Vedanta and Yoga tangible, accessible, and actionable. It translates timeless principles into a language and medium that young people understand and can easily embrace. Thus, it not only offers a path to improved mental wellness but also helps reconnect a generation with the richness of its own cultural and philosophical heritage, fostering a deeper sense of self-awareness and inner equilibrium.

Key innovations include real-world applicability—providing contextual guidance during actual stressful events rather than in controlled clinical settings—and cultural authenticity that deeply aligns with Indian youth while meeting their technological expectations. The immersive content methodology, inspired by relatable storytelling formats, transforms

philosophical teachings into engaging digital-native experiences.

Conclusion

‘The dry, abstract Advaita must become living—poetic—in everyday life; out of hopelessly intricate mythology must come concrete moral forms; and out of bewildering Yogism must come the most scientific and practical psychology—and all this must be put in a form so that a child may grasp it. That is my life’s work’, writes Swami Vivekananda in 1896 from USA in a letter to Alasinga Perumal in Chennai, India. Samsmriti Darshanam is a modern attempt by Ramakrishna Math and Ramakrishna Mission to take up that same work, utilising the most advanced tools of our time—Artificial Intelligence and Mixed Reality—to do precisely what Swamiji envisioned. It translates the ‘intricate mythology’ of our spiritual predecessors, from Sri Ramakrishna’s parables to Swamiji’s own life-transforming incidents, into ‘concrete moral forms’ and ‘spiritual case studies’ that directly address the modern mental health crisis.

This platform is built to put this ‘practical psychology’ into a ‘form so that a child may grasp it’—or, in our case, so that a digitally-native generation grappling with digital overwhelm can internalize it. The technology is not the goal; it is the *upaya* (skillful means) to facilitate the ‘constant remembrance’ (Samsmriti) that all great masters prescribed. By creating immersive, real-time experiences, Samsmriti Darshanam provides the practical training to bridge the gap between ‘grand resolves’ and ‘realized strength,’ transforming the ‘reactive slavery’ of our base instincts into the ‘conscious freedom’ of our higher Self. It is a tool to help us, finally, make the highest Advaita ‘living and poetic’ in every moment of our daily lives. 